



THE HEAT IS ON

The I-League **title race intensifies** as Gokulam Kerala and Sreenidi Deccan continue to challenge Mohammedan SC.

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The I-League title race is heating up, with both Gokulam Kerala and Sreenidi Deccan mounting a serious challenge to the current I-League leader, Mohammedan SC.

Gokulam has registered five wins on the bounce since the competition's resumption this year, while Sreenidi has now won four on the trot. **The top three, as it stands, are separated by just two points.**

The Malabarians have plundered 14 goals in the winning run, with the league top-scorer Alex Sanchez continuing to impress by taking his tally to 15 goals.

Mohammedan, which returned to winning ways with two successive victories, will need to show its mettle in a crucial week, where it will take on both Sreenidi and Gokulam in successive away matches.

It's been a mixed fortnight for fourth-placed

Real Kashmir, which could also come into the title mix, with two contrasting on-field incidents taking the limelight.

Striker Gnohere Krizo scored a stunning goal-of-the-season contender in the win over Churchill Brothers, which was overshadowed by Peter Hartley's accusation that Syrian Shaher Shaheen allegedly spat at him in the ill-tempered 1-1 draw against Inter Kashi.

"17 years I've played professional. Today I was spat into my face by number 16 of @realkashmirfc. I've played in India for 4 years. **This is not acceptable in our sport and certainly not acceptable in this country. I will be exploiting the options to report this player and he's [his] football club.**

"I can't believe we are in 2024 and this kind of misconduct is still happening. Very disappointed and feel the player should be punished for he's actions," Hartley wrote on X.

Tough battle: Tempers flared in the 1-1 draw between Real Kashmir and Churchill Brothers, where Peter Hartley accused Shaher Shaheen of spitting at him. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT